



Top Five Open Source Alternatives To Microsoft Office

Office suites have become common organisational and productivity tools. While Microsoft Office is the most popular suite today, there is a growing demand for more affordable alternatives. Numerous open source office suites have hit the market. Here is a selection of the top five that users can explore and use



Anand Nayyar works at Duy Tan University in Vietnam. He loves to explore open source technologies, sensor communications, network security and the Internet of Things

For the past several years, Microsoft Office has remained the leader in office productivity software offering integrated applications for word processing, spreadsheets, presentations, database management, email handling and, above all, desktop publishing. An office suite is a mandatory part of any operating system's ecosystem. It is difficult to imagine a desktop operating system without office software. Windows has the Microsoft Office suite, which now dominates even the Mac market with Office for Mac. But for the Linux operating system, there are many choices available.

Some of the open source or free alternatives are even better than Microsoft Office when it comes to minimising costs

and their capability to work with office files. However, all office suites are not the same and each has some limitation or the other. One also needs to bear in mind that the formatting of one file type can be saved in different ways for different programs. This can cause problems when sharing files with those using different software. Therefore it's important to ensure that the formatting is retained accurately. On top of that, you also need to ask which types of office software you actually need. Most packages offer documents and spreadsheets as standard, but some providers may not provide database or presentation software in a bundle. So it's important to check what you need and evaluate this against what providers will actually supply.